

BETAR NWFP MANAGEMENT AND MARKETING GROUP

(1st Revision)



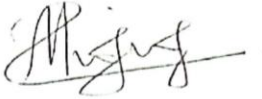
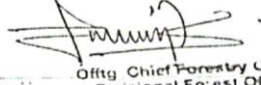
**Betar Village
Samphelling Geog
Chhukha Dzongkhag**

Plan Period: 2023-2028

Approval Sheet

Name of NWFP Management and Marketing Group	Betar NWFP Management and Marketing Group
Dzongkhag	Chhukha
Gewog	Samphelling
Village	Betar
No. of household	16
Area (ha)	2.02
Plan Period	2023-2028

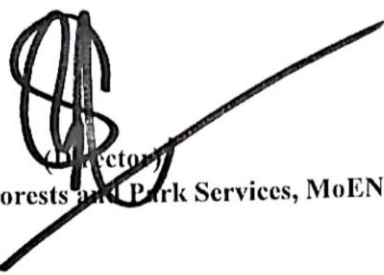
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Signature		
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Approved by:


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Part A: NWFP Management and Marketing Plan**1. Background**

The Betar NWFP Management Group was established in 2014 with support from Dzongkhag Forestry Sector. The Betar NWFP group was designated with 5 acres of SRF land within their vicinity where they have planted with bamboos and other NWFP species. This is the 2nd revision carried out for the group with technical support from Forest Divisional Office, Gedu. The Group is managed by 16 households of Betar communities under Samphelling Gewog. The gewog experiences sub-tropical type of climate with annual rainfall ranging from 1500mm to 4000mm. The area experiences hot summer with heavy rainfall and cool dry winter. Betar village is located at the distance of 2 km (Approx) from Gewog Office.

Agriculture farming and livestock rearing are the main activities being practiced by the people in the village. The main cash crops they grow are ginger and areca nut.

The formation of NWFP management and collection group was initiated mainly to improve income generation of the people of Betar community. To meet the purpose, number of species has been identified and listed for management and collection, and marketing. However, the first 3 years of their management was focused on planting of desired bamboo species and other NWFP species. These species are Bamboo (*Bambusa nutans* and *Bambusa tulda*), *Thysanolaena latifolia* (Kucho), and *Piper Spp* (Pipla). These species will be collected from within the periphery of villages and bamboo plantation site.

The group is mainly formed for the management of potential NWFP resources and maintains the sustainability of same around the village; it will also improve their living standard from income generated through sale of NWFP products.

2. Overall management Goals and Objectives

- Harvesting of NWFPs sustainably (Bamboo and Broom)
- Income generation through sale and proper management of potentially identified NWFPs
- To ensure the sustainability of forest resources; potential NWFPs
- Equitable distribution of potential NWFPs
- Protection of NWFPs from exploitation by outsiders.

3. Location of Bamboo Plantation area.

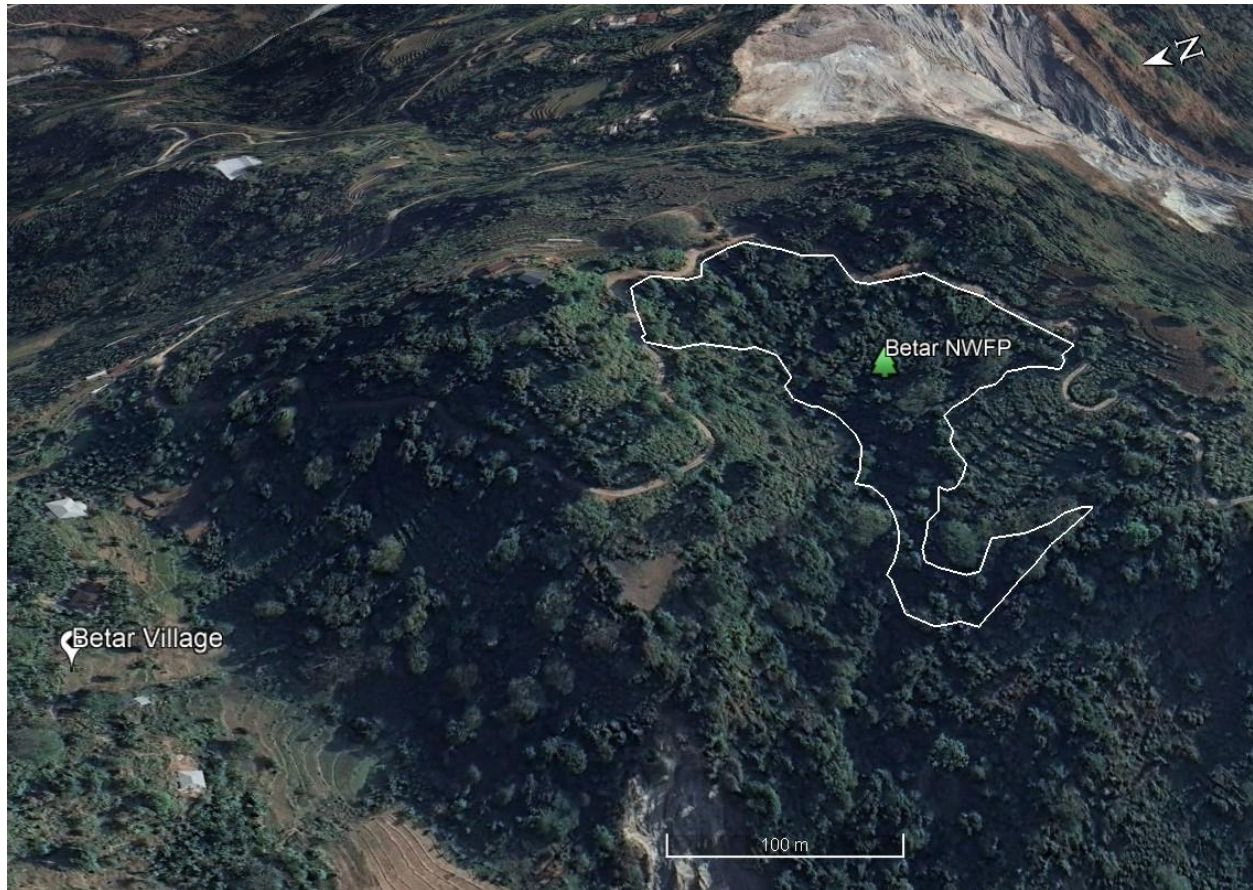


Figure 1. Map of NWFP harvesting area

4. History of First Management and Marketing Plan Cycle.

The Group have mainly focused their First Management Plan cycle for planting the desired bamboo species (*Bambusa nutans* and *Bambusa tulda*) and other NWFP species like *Thysanolaena latifolia* (Kucho), and *Piper Spp* (Pipla). Therefore, the Group was not able to harvest and market any produces from NWFP area. The group have a total saving of Nu. 30000.00 accumulated from membership fees and fines collected from illegal activities. However, the group plans to generate the income from sale of bamboo and other NWFP produces from coming years. The detail management prescriptions are drawn for strengthening the group in future with sustainable harvesting techniques.

5. Description of NWFP present in the area

The Betar NWFP group was designated with 5 acres of SRF land where they have planted the bamboos and broom grass in their first plan cycle. They have two species of bamboo (*Bambusa nutans* and *Bambusa tulda*) and other NWFP species like *Thysanolaena latifolia* (Kucho), whereby *Piper Spp* (Pipla) is grown naturally in the area.

5.1. Location and Potential NWFP Management areas

The sustainable management of the bamboo resources are crucial for the groups members and its is the responsibility of the members to conserve, manage and revive the bamboo resources in the area. The group members had planned for the plantation of bamboo in the NWFP areas.

Table 1. Location and Potential NWFP Management and collection area

Name of the area / location	Total area, ac (approx.)	Walking distance		
Betar Bamboo Plantation area	5.00	10 mins.	Bamboo (Numbers)	Broom (Bundles)
			700	500-1000

Potential NWFP resources

The members had identified non wood forest products for harvesting from the identified collection areas as per the harvesting guidelines.

5.2. Description of NWFP for commercial harvesting in each season

Table 2. Description and harvesting of NWFP for commercial purposes

NWFP Name	Harvesting Area(s) (name)	Parts harvested	Use/Purpose (traditional and others)	Harvesting season (Months)	Estimated quantity for harvest in a season/year
Bamboo	Betar	Bamboo culm and shoot	Construction and vegetable	October-March	700 numbers
Broom	Betar	Broom	Broom	December to March	500-1000 bundles
<i>Pipla</i>	Betar	Fruits	medicines	Mid-September	500 kgs

6. Prescription for sustainable harvesting of NWFPs.

The prescriptions for sustainable harvesting of NWFPs are provided as follows:

Table 3. Harvesting prescriptions for various NWFPs.

NWFP Species	Harvesting prescription
Bamboo	Harvesting of Bamboo In general, Culm selection system for harvesting should be adopted. The felling cycle of 3-5 years is most suitable for bamboo. Immature culms of less than 1 year old should not be cut.

(*Bambusa nutans* and
Bambusa tulda)

In a clump, at least 50% of the matured culms over 1 year old should be retained OR all should be retained during felling if a clump has less than 4 matured culms over 1 year old culms.

Harvesting Guidelines

In a clump containing 12 culms or more, at least 6 matured culms over 1 year old should be retained.

Matured culms should be retained evenly distributed throughout the clump to provide mechanical support.

Culms, 3 years and above can be harvested.

Culms should be overcrowded at base.

Culm should not be cut lower than the first node above the ground.

Thinning reduces rhizome overcrowding and encourages the production of new culms.

Culm Harvesting Guideline

Collect culm from November to February.

Do not cut culm less than 1 year old.

Retain 50% of healthy culms from a clump.

Culms, in congested clump should be harvested in 'U' or 'Horse shoe' forms.

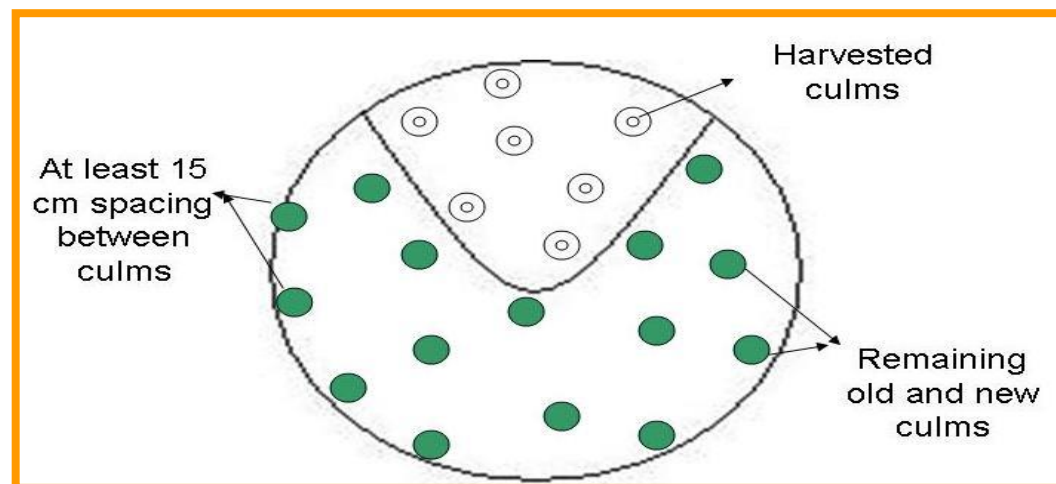
Otherwise, opt for single culm selection method.

Distance between two culms should be at least 15cm.

Culm should be cut slanting using sharp knife/saw.

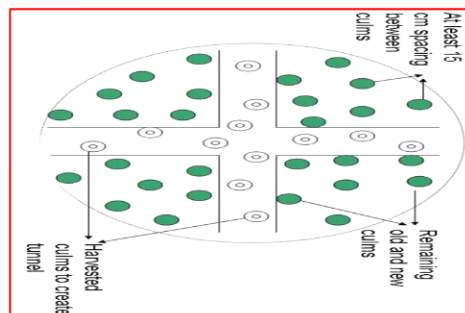
Harvesting Methods

Horse shoe methods:



In horse shoe method, bamboo culms are harvested in horse shoe pattern (as shown in the diagram, above).

Matured/old culms are removed along with the weak, diseased, dying and dead culms from the middle of the clump and remaining clump are managed with the healthy culms.



	The system is suitable in very spread and/or large and congested clumps. The adoption of system will ease in culm harvesting. Tunnel Method: Tunnels are made cutting through the center of the clump, dividing it into four parts. Culms of all ages are cut to create a passage which will allow easy access and extraction of culms even from the middle of the clump. Size of the tunnel depends on the size of the clump, usually more than 30cm. Bamboo Pruning and thinning For bamboo species that have heavy branches at the lower nodes like <i>Bambusa stricta</i>, pruning needs to be done to reduce culms congestion. The twisted and small culms should be thinned out to create space Infected, injured, dead, and dying culms should be removed to create space and clean environment within the clump, and to help young and productive culms to develop. Thinning will facilitate extraction and harvesting of matured culms. Pruning and thing should be carried out during dry or winter season, before shoot formation takes place.
<i>Thysanolaena latifolia</i> (Kuchu)	The species should be harvested in the month of December to March. The basic guidelines for harvesting are: Do not collect all plants from the area. Maintain few healthy stems in a group. Use proper tools and do not uproot.
<i>Piper spp</i> (Pipla)	The species can be collected from Mid-March till Mid-September depending on the type of species. The basic guidelines to be followed are: Collect the fruits when fully mature. Do not uproot or cut down the entire climber. Harvest fruits only after the announced date for harvesting. Harvest fruits and spikes by hand picking without damaging the plants or by cutting a few bearing branches

7. Marketing and sales plan for the group

The harvesting of each NWFPs species shall be done in the harvesting period with valid collection permits. The collected NWFPs shall be sold in the market identified by the members. Most of the collected NWFPs will be marketed to the capital city of Bhutan and Phuntsholing, and members shall explore other possible market within the country.

Table 4. Marketing and sales plan

NWFP	Potential Market	Estimated quantity to sale annually	Form of products (dry/Fresh)	Expected price per unit	Total (Nu)	Marketing arrangements
Bamboo	Phuntsholing	700 to 1000	Fresh	70/piece	70,000.00	The products will

	and Thimphu	numbers				be marketed in Samphelling and Phuntsholing area. Additional market opportunities will be explored in Thimphu and other districts.
Broom	Phuntsholing	500-1000 Bundles	Dry	30/bundle	30,000.00	
Pipla	Phuntsholing	100 kgs	Dry	500/kg	5000.00	

8. Benefits to the members

- Free access of product to the member for self-consumption
- The members may avail loan from the group saving

9. Benefits to the group

- The fund from the group saving may be used for Community Developmental activities
- The NWFPs can be managed in a sustainable manner
- Protection of NWFPs from illicit harvesting and over exploitations

Part B: By-Laws

10. Membership Arrangement

10.1. Membership eligibility

- Households having a registered, either thram or gung are eligible to join the group
- Households having the traditional rights over the declared forest area for the management of potential NWFPs holds the rights to become the new member

10.2. Procedure to become a new member

- Submit the joining application to the chairperson
- Final decision will be made in the presence of all the group members: New member (s) will be allowed to join the group only after the realization of Nu. 10000.00 (Ten Thousand) only as an entry fee.

10.3. Procedure for withdrawing from the group

- Submit withdrawing application to the chairperson
- However, final decision will be made after the close consultation with all the group members
 - With genuine reasons: Withdrawing member (s) with genuine reason will get 50% of his total accumulated budget in Group's savings. H/S will be allowed to re-join the group

- Without genuine reason: Withdrawing from the group without genuine reason (s) will not get any benefits. H/S will be not allowed to re-join the group

11. Roles and Responsibilities executive members and group members

11.1. Chairperson

- Co-ordinate and monitor group activities
- Attend and chair any of the group-related meetings
- Collect and present the market information
- Implementation of management plan
- Initiate the seasonal collection of identified NWFPs
- Maintain the records of activities carried out
- Maintain and strengthen the relations with other stakeholders and seek technical backstopping from appropriate agency (ies)
- Obtain NWFP collection permit
- Attend official correspondences
- Conflict resolution
- Joint signatory authority with treasurer
- Identify profitable trader/exporter

11.2. Secretary

- Officiate Chairperson
- Guide and monitor the seasonal collection of potentially identified NWFPs
- Maintain the minutes of the meetings

11.3. Treasurer

- Opening of Group account book (Signatory authority with Chairperson)
- Collection and deposition of membership fee
- Collection and deposition of fines and penalties
- Maintain and present group's financial records during meetings
- Maintain records of NWFP collected by the members
- Assist other executive members in storing collected NWFPs

11.4. Members' Roles and Responsibilities

- Labor contribution
- Election and termination of executive members
- Auditing
- Collection of NWFPs as per the prescribed guidelines
- Participated in any group-related activities

12. Financial Arrangement

1. Membership fee Nu 500/- will be collected annually. The annual fee will be collected on first week of January month.
2. 30% of total sale value of collected will be deducted to deposit in group's saving.
3. Fines and Penalties:
 - ✓ 100 % of the total fine collected at a time, will be deposited in the group fund
4. The group will be benefited from bank loan interest
5. The group fund will be raised from donations and contribution.

12.1. Fund Utilization

Activity	Fund allocated
Purchase of office stationeries	5%
Group developmental activities	60%
Entertaining guest/visitor	5%
Provision for death within members and victims of natural calamities	30%

- ✓ Maximum loan within the group will be given Nu 10,000/- at the interest of 9% and no loan will be provided to non-members.
- ✓ But the group will not allow to withdraw the accumulated fund till the total accumulated fund amounts to Nu 10,000/-.

13. Benefit Sharing

13.1. Sharing of NWFP resources

- ✚ During the resource collecting time, equal collector from each household needs to be ensured by the executive members.
- ✚ If h/s is not able to come for collecting the resource (Bamboo, pipla, and broom), the representative may be sent, but should be one of h/h family members
- ✚ Only one member can collect the resource from individual household at a time per day
- ✚ Collector should be at least 18 years and above.

13.2. Sharing of financial benefits

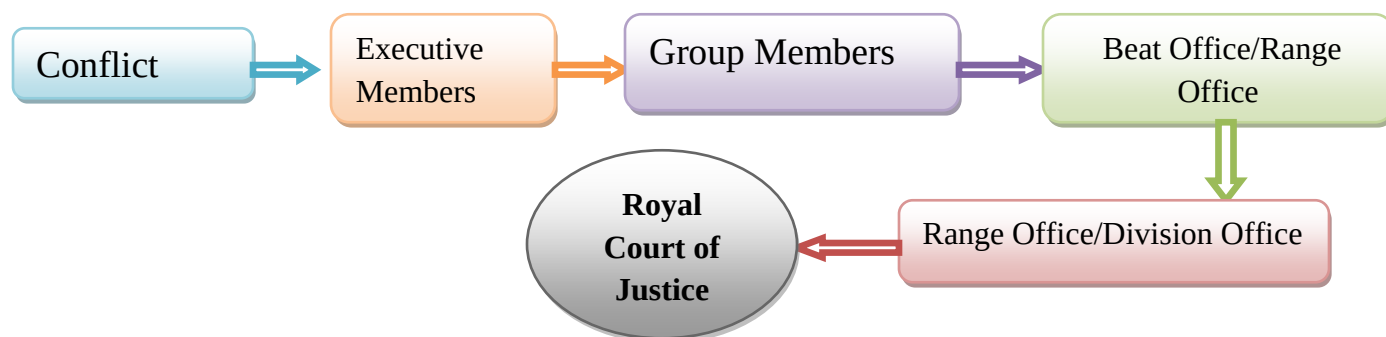
- ✚ The members will be benefited from 70% of total sale value of product (NWFP) collected by h/h
- ✚ Loan will be provided from the group's accumulated budget on need basis after verification by the executive members.
 - ✓ Loans will be provided during death and during house destruction by natural calamities

14. Meeting

- General meeting will be conducted twice in a year where executive meeting will be conducted four times a year.
- Executive members will call upon the presence of group members for any emergency meetings, if needed to be conducted.

15. Marketing Arrangement

- ❖ Chairman and executive members will find the market and/or trader. (Trader could be outsiders or Bhutanese)
- ❖ The group will decide and fix the product price based on existing market price
- ❖ The group will decide in general meeting for the sale of products.
- ❖ Group will collect the products and make ready for marketing.
- ❖ Treasurer will ensure the proper recording of the products collected by the members.

16. Conflict Resolution

17. Fines and Penalties

The fines and penalties prescribed for each offence are provided below:

Table 5. Fines and penalties

Sl.No.	Activity	Fines and penalties	Remarks
01.	Illegal collection of the products	Nu.500/- per individual per day and will keep multiplying Nu 500/- if caught same person for several times.	Products will be Release
02.	Collection/extraction of products by the members before/after the prescribed time/season.	Nu.500/-per day per individual	Products will be release
03.	Violation of harvesting guidelines	Nu.25/- per plant	Rehabilitation activities will be done by community
	1. Broom		
	2. Pipla	Nu.25- per plant	
	3. Bamboo	Nu.200/-per plant	
04.	Felling of whole host plant	Report to the nearest forest office for legal action.	
05.	Individual selling of NWFPs	Nu.300/- with the payment of total sale value of the products sold.	
06.	Late comers in any group-related activities	Nu.500/- only	If h/s arrives after first 1 hour. H/s will be considered as an absentee.
07.	Absentee	Nu.500/- per day	Will be asked to leave the group after three consecutive warnings.
08.	Misuse of group fund by the treasurer (and executive members)	Refund the total misused fund with the interest (Prevailing govt. interest rate)	Re-election for the post.
09.	Delay in loan refunding	If he/she could not pay the loan on dateline, the principal amount will be double every year.	If h/s is not able to refund the loan even after the passage of three consecutive datelines, the matter will be forwarded to the Geog Administration and/or follow the conflict resolution procedures.

18. Monitoring of activities

- The monitoring of illegal activities in the Betar NWFP designated area will be done by the NWFP group members, coordinate by the Chairman and committee members.
- The collection of identified NWFPs will be monitor by the chairman and Committee members with the assist from forest officials.
- Monitoring of Plan implementation will be done by the NWFP collection and marketing group members with the assist from forest officials.

19. Evaluation of NWFP Collection and Marketing Group Plan

The plan will be evaluated based on the following objectives: -

1	Income generation	✓ Bank balance ✓ Living standard of NWFP groups
2	Conservation	✓ Improved forest stand
3	Rehabilitate	✓ Area rehabilitates through plantation
4	Protection	✓ Reduce the illicit activities

Annexure 1. Lists of NWFP Management Group, Betar Village, Samphelling Gewog

Sl/No	Name	CID Number	House No	Thram No	Contact No
1	Janga Bdr Ghalley	10201000189	Kha-1-527	81	77262665
2	Dik Bdr Ghally (B)	10201000210	Kha-1-564	1332	
3	Yogo Maya Ghalley	11215000250	Kha-1-129	1492	
4	Dik Bdr Ghalley (A)	10201002904	Kha-1-134	162	77348511
5	Lek Raj Ghalley	10201000190	Kha-1-130	1690	77385544
6	Bakta Singh Ghalley	10201000175	Kha-1-129	77	17940367
7	Man Mati Rai	10201000105	Kha-1-133	159	77766703
8	Nar Bdr Ghalley	10201000035	Kha-1-128	126	17470476
9	Durga Bdr Ghalley	10201000211	Kha-1-138	1273	17914313
10	Telak Bdr Ghalley	10201002908	Kha-1-134	161	77770901
11	Ghan Bdr Ghalley	10201003312	Kha-1-124	78	17466087
12	Lal Man Ghalley	10201000176	Kha-1-129	1275	77830053
13	Dhal Bdr Ghalley	10201000939	Kha-1-127	141	17543642
14	Dhan Bdr Ghalley	10201000162	Kha-1-122		
15	Bhim Bdr Ghalley	10201000160	Kha-1-126		
16	Dhan Bdr Ghalley	30201000002	Kha-1-		